Grayson Iller

Flight Test Engineer Lead, Device Platform

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linkedin.com/in/grayson-iller-a119b2202 | Portfolio | vueniverse.com

SUMMARY

Three years at Skydio validating the controller experience for public safety and national security operators. I map critical user journeys, model system state, and find the places where the interface and the aircraft disagree. Designed and built VUE solo, from Figma to production. Applying to move from validating these interfaces to designing them.

EXPERIENCE

Skydio | Flight Test Engineer Lead, Device Platform | San Mateo, CA | June 2023 to Present

- Modeled controller-to-drone connectivity as a state machine to find states where the UI reported normal operation while the link was degraded, then worked with engineering on how the UI should represent them.
- Authored over 5,500 test cases in TestRail across the S2, X2, and X10 Enterprise platforms, organized by operator flow rather than subsystem; wrote the impact assessment when the suite was restructured by feature, showing regression time grew from 3.5 to over 4 weeks.
- Bridged UX and system-level testing by evaluating real operator workflows and usability under pressure, with a focus on clarity, predictability, and real-world use in public safety and defense.
- On-site at Redwood City PD for controller radio-interference validation with Wireless and EE; ran the RF interference test matrix that fed the hardware rework. FAA Part 107 certified.
- Manage a direct report who owns mobile device platform validation; absorbed a second validation program for national security customers when its lead left.
- Test lead for the next-generation enterprise controller from early bring-up through Alpha and Beta, identifying integration gaps across controller, mobile, and vehicle systems.
- Built Jira dashboards for release risk and triage and ran the bug scrub cadence where severity is argued on reproduction, logs, and user impact.

Skydio | Flight Test Intern, UI/Human Factors | May 2022 to August 2022

- Mobile-side flight test: UI/UX feature testing and drone system validation with hardware and software teams, using TestRail, Jira, Instabug, and Figma.

PROJECTS

VUE (vueniverse.com) | Founder, Designer, Engineer | 2024 to Present

- Fashion intelligence platform that aggregates daily new arrivals from 100+ women's fashion brands into one personalized feed. Live in production with real users and affiliate monetization.
- Designed end to end in Figma and FigJam first, then developed with AI-assisted coding workflows using Claude.
- Removed the sign-up wall after retention data showed visitors who opened a product returned at 50% versus 6% for those who did not; moved auth to the point of intent (first follow or save).
- Ran a design audit that collapsed three auth screens and six button styles into one system: one accent, one type scale, 44px minimum touch targets, WCAG 2.1 AA contrast.

SKILLS

Design: Critical user journeys, information architecture, system state modeling, Figma and FigJam, design systems, interaction design

Skydio systems: connectivity switching (direct radio and LTE), activation and login, media, support logs, controller-only releases, next-generation controller bring-up, on-prem deployments

Research: Field validation with public safety operators, usability testing, bug scrub and program review, FAA Part 107

Build: React 18, TypeScript, Tailwind, Supabase, Vercel, AI-assisted development with Claude

Tools: Jira, TestRail, Instabug, Git/GitHub

EDUCATION

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University | B.S. Human Factors Psychology (HCI focus), Minor in Aerospace Physiology | 2019 to 2023

NCAA Division II Women's Cross Country and Track & Field. FAA-certified UAV pilot. PADI Open Water Diver. Olympic-distance triathlon finisher.

PUBLICATIONS

- Tooker, M., Iller, G., French, J., McGrath, B., & Rupert, A. (2022). Pilot-in-the-loop technology for moon landings. IAF/IAA Space Life Sciences Symposium.
- Crichton, C., Delgado, L., Iller, G., et al. (2021). The Link Between Spatial Disorientation in Flight and Mild Hypoxia. Reno Aerospace Medicine Convention.